

JOSE ANTONIO ELIZALDE

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles

Sept 2025 – Dec 2027

B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering

Westwood, CA

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Object-Oriented C++, Computer Architecture, Discrete Mathematics, Physics, Game Development, Game Programming, Game Engines

Experience

UCLA ACM Studio | Jump The Gun | *Unity, C#, Git* – Game Director

Oct 2025 – Present

- Directed design and development of a single-player **first-person action shooter** built around fast, close-range combat, defining the **gameplay mechanics** and coordinating implementation across a team of **8** game programmers and artists.
- Wrote the custom **physics-based movement controller** in **C#**, replacing **Unity's** built-in character controller with hand-written movement and **collision logic** so the game's feel is original rather than inherited from the engine default.
- Maintained the team by reviewing and integrating gameplay features developed concurrently by multiple contributors with **Git branching**, **pull-request/code review** and weekly team meetings.

Game Projects

Cloudy Critters | *Unity, C#, Blender* – Gameplay Programmer, team of 20

Aug 2026 – Present

- Built **gameplay systems** for a city-builder/deck-builder roguelike tycoon on a **20-person team**, where players construct a sky zoo and clear point quotas scored against their animal enclosures.
- Implemented the **card ability system** covering **15+ distinct card effects** and their resolution rules, plus the **multi-island expansion** feature that lets players grow their zoo outward.
- Modeled **10+ animals and habitats** in **Blender** and integrated them into **Unity** as game-ready assets, covering both the gameplay code and the **3D content** it drives.

Shellscape | *Unity, C#, WebGL* – Gameplay Programmer, team of 5

Aug 2026

- Shipped a browser-playable action game with a team of five UCLA students for Club Club Jam Jam 2026, designed and completed inside a game jam window, placing **74th out of roughly 150 teams**, and released publicly on **itch.io**.
- Implemented the **movement and interaction systems**, including the **body-possession mechanic** the whole game is built around: the player has no shell of their own and takes over enemy bodies to borrow their weapons.
- Built the **tutorial scene**, including the scripted narration and **dialogue box system** that teaches the possession mechanic.

One Tap Cook | *Unity, C#, WebGL* – Gameplay Programmer, team of 5

Nov 2025

- Shipped a browser-playable cooking game with a team of five UCLA students for Studio Game Jam 2025 within a **72-hour** game jam window, and released it publicly on **itch.io**.
- Built the game around a **career-ladder progression** in which the player rises from a fast-food line to a Michelin-star kitchen, with each rung played as a timed minigame and the run ending in a full plated meal.
- Designed and implemented **two of the game's minigames**, Wheel of Death and a rhythm-tap sequence, along with the full **UI/UX**, music, and **sound effects** layer.

Personal Developer Portfolio | *React, Vite, React-router*

Aug 2026 – Sept 2026

- Engineered a responsive, high-performance developer portfolio to showcase software engineering projects, technical skills, and academic research.
- Architected the frontend UI/UX using modern web technologies, optimizing for cross-device accessibility, Lighthouse performance metrics, and SEO.
- Configured a **CI/CD** workflow connected to GitHub so pushes to main build and publish the site automatically.

Research Experience

Carnegie Mellon University – REUSE Research Program

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Undergraduate Researcher, Human-Computer Interaction Institute (HCII)

Pittsburgh, PA

- Built an interactive application studying whether gamified in-ride interactions can improve communication and empathy between rideshare drivers and passengers, refining its features from **usability testing across nine workshops**.
- Co-authored ***Beyond Riding: Passenger Engagement with Driver Labor through Gamified Interactions***, accepted to **CHI 2026** (ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, Barcelona).

Technical Skills

Engines & Tools: Unity, Blender, Git/GitHub, Visual Studio, Vim/NeoVim

Languages: C#, C++, C, Python, TypeScript, Bash

Gameplay: character controllers, physics and collision, ability/card systems, state machines, UI and dialogue systems

Production: game direction, scope and milestone planning, Git branching and pull-request review, playtest iteration